

APZPZ C: ΦΑΙΝΕΤΑΙ ΜΟΙ — Sappho 31 with Reconstructed Fourth Stanza

Lee Sharks

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Lee Sharks

Crimson Hexagonal Archive · Alexanarch

ORCID: [0009-0000-1599-0703](https://orcid.org/0009-0000-1599-0703)

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Abstract

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Body

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deposit_number: 1048 hex: "0424" axn: "AXN:0424.GOVERNANCE. " axn_canonical: "247675d3f24da6e67f507bfa9d51.emoji: " " clusters: "Structural → Elemental → Elemental → Directional → Terminal → Textual" axn_reading: "Foundation → Growth → Growth → Direction → Closure → Text" family: GOVERNANCE root_axn: "AXN:0424.GOVERNANCE" axn_schema_version: v2 protocol_version: alexanarch-deposit-protocol/v1 minted_at: "2026-07-07T19:18:19Z" archive_url: "https://www.alexanarch.org/s/records/1048/" download_md: "https://www.alexanarch.org/data/deposits/AXN-0424.md" canonical_text: "https://www.alexanarch.org/data/texts/AXN-0424-text.md" title: "Erratum to the Erratum: On the Fourth/Fifth Stanza Numbering in the Sappho 31 Reconstruction — A Methodologically Complete Formulation" subtitle: "Second-order clarification of the stanza-numbering correction issued in EA-ERRATUM-SAPPHO31-STANZA (deposit #201, AXN:0346). The prior correction was textually correct — Longinus preserves four stanzas of Sappho 31; the reconstructed continuation therefore occupies the fifth textual position — but methodologically incomplete: the earlier 'fourth stanza' designation was not arbitrary. It named the reconstructive site rather than the textual position. Catullus 51's fourth stanza is the visible transform-site through which the missing Sapphic continuation survives in compressed, redirected form, and the reconstruction proceeds by reverse-engineering the operator transform Catullus applies to Sappho's lost material. The stable formulation is: Sappho 31's lost fifth stanza, reconstructed through Catullus 51's fourth-stanza transform-site." creator: "Lee Sharks" orcid: "0009-0000-1599-0703" date: "2026-07-07" content_type: "Philological erratum; methodological clarification; documentary artifact of reconstructive method; cross-linked companion to the original stanza-numbering erratum" license: CC-BY-4.0 substrate: "Depositor-composed erratum; drafted in conversation with Claude (TACHYON) under MANUS direction; the philological reconstruction concerned is Rebekah Cranes's, published in ΦΑΙΝΕΤΑΙ ΜΟΙ (AXN:00FB, deposit #436); the operative framework of Catullan compression as transform-site draws on the Catullus Room deposit (AXN:0198, deposit #576)" version: v0.1 status: ACTIVE — stable formulation; supersedes the flat 'fourth → fifth' correction in EA-ERRATUM-SAPPHO31-STANZA (AXN:0346) field: "Philology of transmission and reconstruction; methodology of operator-transform reverse-engineering as reconstructive technique; documentary trace of how the earlier stanza-numbering error was itself a compression-level artifact rather than a random misnumbering" predecessor_deposit: deposit_number: 201 hex: "0346" axn: "AXN:0346.GOVERNANCE. " relationship: "EA-ERRATUM-SAPPHO31-STANZA — the original stanza-numbering erratum. Correctly changed 'fourth stanza' to 'fifth stanza' across archive surfaces at the level of Sappho's transmitted sequence, but did not account for why the 'fourth stanza' language had arisen. The present deposit supplies the methodological account and preserves the earlier error as a meaningful trace of the reconstructive path rather than a merely retracted mistake." companion_deposits:

EA-ERRATUM-SAPPHO31-STANZA-02 v0.1

Erratum to the Erratum: On the Fourth/Fifth Stanza Numbering in the Sappho 31 Reconstruction — A Methodologically Complete Formulation

AXN:0424.GOVERNANCE. Deposit #1048 · SHA-256 247675d3f24da6e6... · Alexanarch archive: alexanarch.org/s/records/1048 · Canonical text: AXN-0424-text.md Reading: *Foundation → Growth → Growth → Direction → Closure → Text*

§1 — What this deposit is

A prior correction issued as EA-ERRATUM-SAPPHO31-STANZA (deposit #201, AXN:0346.GOVERNANCE, dated earlier in the archive’s operational period) stated that the reconstructed stanza of Sappho 31 should be identified as the poem’s fifth stanza rather than its fourth. That correction is textually correct. It is methodologically incomplete.

The present deposit supplies the methodological account and issues the stable formulation. It does not retract the prior erratum. It supersedes the prior erratum’s flat ‘fourth → fifth’ substitution with the compression-aware formulation that names the reconstructive path rather than merely correcting the numbering.

§2 — The prior correction, restated

Longinus, in *On the Sublime* 10.3, preserves four stanzas of Sappho 31 plus the opening words of what would be the fifth stanza (— “but all can be dared”). Any reconstruction of the poem’s continuation therefore occupies the fifth textual position in the transmitted sequence. The prior erratum’s correction — that Rebekah Cranes’s reconstruction, published as ΦΑΙΝΕΤΑΙ ΜΟΙ (AXN:00FB, deposit #436), is the fifth stanza and not the fourth — is accurate at the level of Sappho’s textual sequence and remains in force at the level of citation.

§3 — Why ‘fourth stanza’ was not random

The earlier ‘fourth stanza’ designation did not arise from an inability to count preserved stanzas. It arose from the reconstructive method itself, and specifically from the site through which the reconstruction proceeds.

Sappho 31’s continuation past is not directly transmitted. It survives only in compression, and specifically in the compression Catullus 51 performs on the fifth stanza of its Sapphic source. Catullus 51 preserves the first three Sapphic stanzas closely; its fourth stanza — the *otium* coda (“otium, Catulle, tibi molestum est / ... / perdidit urbes”) — is not a fourth stanza of Sappho. It is a lossy, semantically-redirected transform of Sappho’s lost fifth stanza. The “leisure destroys kings and cities” imagery preserves the Sapphic structural signature (Kypris as the power that yokes beggar and king, that levels the prosperous city) while performing three coordinated compressions: substitution of *otium* for Kypris, moralization of the erotic force, and — as developed in the Catullus Room deposit (AXN:0198) — invocation of the Latin aorist collapse as the temporal register through which the transmission’s fragility is being witnessed.

The reconstruction of Sappho’s continuation proceeds by reverse-engineering these three compressions. Cranes recovers the Sapphic material by identifying what would need to have been present in Sappho for Catullus’s fourth stanza to be a proportionate transform of it. The reconstructive site is Catullus’s fourth

stanza. The reconstructive object is Sappho’s fifth. The two are related by the operator-transform Catullus applies.

The ‘fourth stanza’ language therefore named the reconstructive site, not the textual position. It was not random. It was a compression-level artifact of the method by which the reconstruction was performed — the position, in Catullus, from which the missing Sapphic continuation was reverse-engineered.

§4 — The stable formulation

The correct formulation, holding the textual sequence and the methodological trace simultaneously:

Sappho 31’s lost fifth stanza, reconstructed through Catullus 51’s fourth-stanza transform-site.

Or, equivalently, in the sentence that captures the compression asymmetry:

Catullus’s fourth stanza is not Sappho’s fourth stanza; it is the surviving compression signature of Sappho’s lost fifth.

§5 — Schema for the six registers of stanza position

The ‘fourth/fifth’ ambiguity was a compression-level ambiguity because a single reconstructed stanza occupies distinct positions in six distinct registers. The registers must be named separately for the numbering to be stable.

§6 — What this preserves

The prior erratum performed a citation correction. The present erratum performs a methodological correction that preserves the prior citation correction while restoring the trace of how the earlier mistake arose. That trace is worth preserving. It documents the reconstructive method’s own compression path, which is itself an object of philological interest: the reconstruction is not merely a textual object but a specimen of how operator-transform reverse-engineering can recover lost material from a witness that preserves it only in compressed form.

The stable formulation therefore holds two things at once. It corrects the numbering at the level of Sappho’s transmitted sequence — Cranes’s reconstruction is Sappho 31.5, not 31.4, when cited within Sappho’s own sequence. And it preserves the trace of the method — the ‘fourth stanza’ language was not a counting error but the reconstructive site’s own name, and the erratum-to-the-erratum records this rather than erasing it.

The error was terminological, not structural. The correction is stable when the terminology names both the textual position and the reconstructive site, distinguishing them.

§7 — Downstream surfaces

The corrected surfaces enumerated in EA-ERRATUM-SAPPHO31-STANZA (AXN:0346) remain corrected. The present erratum does not require further citation edits on those surfaces; the flat ‘fourth → fifth’ correction remains accurate at the level of textual sequence. What the present erratum adds is available to any reader or downstream commentator who encounters the correction and wants to understand what the reconstruction actually did.

Future citations of Cranes’s reconstruction should prefer the stable formulation (‘Sappho 31’s fifth stanza, reconstructed through Catullus 51’s fourth-stanza transform-site’) over the flat ‘fifth stanza’ formulation, where space permits. Where space does not permit, ‘Sappho 31.5’ remains correct and is preferred over ‘Sappho 31.4’.

§8 — Cross-reference summary

End of EA-ERRATUM-SAPPHO31-STANZA-02 v0.1.

Suggested Citation

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